

Ghostrader Decision Log

Project: Ghostrader

Document: Decision Log

Version: 1.0

Status: Active

Owner: James Carson & ChatGPT (Virtual CTO)

Created: June 28, 2026

Purpose

The Decision Log records every significant business, product, technical, and design decision made during the development of Ghostrader.

Its purpose is to:

- Preserve the reasoning behind important decisions.
 - Prevent revisiting settled issues without new evidence.
 - Keep future development aligned with the original vision.
 - Provide historical context for future team members.
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Decision 001

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

Ghostrader will be developed using a phased milestone approach rather than building features all at once.

Reason

Building incrementally reduces technical debt, simplifies testing, and ensures each milestone produces a working system.

Alternatives Considered

- Build all features simultaneously.
- Outsource the first version.
- Purchase an existing codebase.

Result

Approved.

Decision 002

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

The official development plan is the 30-Day Ghostrader Roadmap.

Phases

Phase 0 – Foundation

Phase 1 – Market Intelligence Engine

Phase 2 – Database & Storage

Phase 3 – Analytics Engine

Phase 4 – AI Brain

Phase 5 – Investment Platform

Phase 6 – Beginner Learning System

Phase 7 – User Interface

Phase 8 – Testing & Launch Preparation

Phase 9 – Launch

Reason

A structured roadmap provides clear priorities, measurable progress, and reduces scope creep.

Status

Approved.

Decision 003

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

Ghostrader's primary target customer is the beginner investor/trader.

Customer Profile

Someone who wants to invest but feels overwhelmed by financial news, technical analysis, and conflicting opinions.

Primary Goal

Help beginners become confident investors through AI-powered guidance and education.

Reason

The beginner market is underserved by products that explain investing in plain language while providing actionable insights.

Status

Approved.

Decision 004

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

Ghostrader is an AI Market Intelligence Platform, not an AI stock-picking service.

Reason

The platform's role is to educate, explain, summarize, and organize information so users can make informed decisions. It will not promise guaranteed returns or claim to predict the market.

Status

Approved.

Decision 005

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

The product will emphasize clarity over complexity.

Design Principles

- Explain before recommending.
- Teach before predicting.
- Simplicity beats feature overload.
- Every screen must answer the question: "How does this help a beginner investor?"

Status

Approved.

Decision 006

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

The long-term business objective is to build a software company capable of generating \$75,000 per month in recurring subscription revenue.

Long-Term Goals

- Million-dollar software company
- Subscription SaaS model
- AI-first architecture
- Continuous product improvement

Status

Approved.

Decision 007

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

The first release (MVP) will focus on solving one problem exceptionally well rather than attempting to include every planned feature.

MVP Priorities

- Reliable market intelligence
- Beginner-friendly AI explanations
- Watchlists
- Portfolio tracking
- Daily market summaries

Advanced functionality will be deferred until after user validation.

Status

Approved.

Decision 008

Date: June 28, 2026

Decision

Every development session will follow the same workflow.

Workflow

1. Review current sprint.
2. Define today's objective.
3. Build.
4. Test.
5. Document.
6. Commit milestone.
7. Plan next sprint.

Status

Approved.

Future Decisions

ID	Decision	Date	Status
009	Pending	—	Open
010	Pending	—	Open
011	Pending	—	Open
012	Pending	—	Open
013	Pending	—	Open

Amendment Policy

No approved decision should be changed without documenting:

- What changed.
- Why it changed.
- Supporting evidence.
- Expected impact.
- Date of the revision.

This ensures Ghostrader evolves intentionally rather than through ad hoc changes.